



THE HINDU PHOTO LIBRARY

2

The DY Patil Stadium in Navi Mumbai will host five matches of the ICC Women's World Cup 2025, replacing Bengaluru's M. Chinnaswamy Stadium, the ICC confirmed. The venue change follows the Karnataka State Cricket Association's failure to secure government clearance. Bengaluru's role in the tournament had already been in doubt after the tragic stampede earlier this year during celebrations of Royal Challengers Bengaluru's IPL triumph.



K. MURALI KUMAR

3

Harmanpreet Kaur will captain India at the ICC Women's ODI World Cup 2025, with Smriti Mandhana as vice-captain, the BCCI announced. This will be Harmanpreet's fifth World Cup appearance but her first as skipper. She and Mandhana will anchor a batting unit that also features Jemimah Rodrigues, while opener Shafali Verma has been left out. All-rounder Deepti Sharma and left-arm spinner Radha Yadav will spearhead the spin department, with Renuka Singh leading the pace attack. Richa Ghosh and Yastika Bhatia have been named as wicketkeeping options. India begins its campaign against Sri Lanka in Bengaluru on September 30, with the marquee clash against Pakistan set for October 5.



REUTERS

4

Former South Africa captain Dane van Niekerk could be set for an international comeback after being named in the training squad for the Women's ODI World Cup. Van Niekerk announced her retirement in March 2023, shortly after being left out of South Africa's home T20 World Cup for failing to meet fitness standards. Since then, she has been playing domestically for Western Province and recently made herself available for national selection. The 31-year-old last featured for South Africa in September 2021. An ankle injury kept her out of the 2022 ODI World Cup, and she was not considered for the 2023 T20 World Cup.



AFP

5

Afghanistan will host Bangladesh for six white-ball internationals in the UAE this October, soon after the conclusion of the Asia Cup on September 28. The series begins with T20Is in Sharjah on October 2, 3 and 5, followed by ODIs in Abu Dhabi on October 8, 11 and 14. This tour was initially scheduled as an all-format series in July 2024 in Greater Noida, India, but was postponed due to bad weather and Bangladesh's congested calendar. The rescheduled version now features only limited-overs cricket.